

Entrepreneurs Qualified by Death

Open to Mark 10, and stick a marker there. Then go to Matthew 19. We will begin around verse 16.

We have been studying prerequisites to answered prayer. Jesus said:

Seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you.

Seek the kingdom of God first, and His righteousness--His right standing in it--and all the things the Gentiles seek after from birth to the grave will simply be added to you.

He would not tell us to seek the kingdom without telling us how. In the beginning of Matthew 6, which we have been studying, He gave three things in seeking the kingdom: when you give, when you pray, and when you fast.

Contained within these three things are prerequisites for prayer. They cause things to happen. They change things in your life, things that must be in place for answered prayer.

Now the Holy Spirit has led me into almsgiving, prosperity, and giving. We are getting into the prerequisites involved in going before God and actually having Him hear and answer your prayer for prosperity and giving.

I want you to extend your faith this way and agree with me. I have not been able to get certain things out of my spirit these last two days. One was a statement made by Jesus:

I say not unto you, that I will pray the Father for you: for the Father himself loveth you, because ye have loved me.

The day He was talking about is today. We are living in our covenant. He said He would not pray the Father for us in that day, because the Father Himself loves us.

That is the part I have not been able to explore thoroughly. He Himself loves you because you have loved Me.

I got into a place in meditation and prayer today where I heard Him say things like, "My firstborn." He called Jesus "My firstborn." He spoke of the love He has for His firstborn.

He began giving me examples. If I am going to enter into my Father's presence with a petition, then I want to know what causes my petition to be heard. I do not believe in praying for prayer's sake. He does not hear that anyway. When you pray, you must esteem yourself in His presence, or forget it.

He said things like this:

What if you, a father, had a younger son who went to Vietnam, was caught in an interrogation prison, and was tortured almost beyond acceptable limits? Then your elder son went and got him out, and in the process was tortured himself. Finally, the older brother carried him out and got him home. The younger son kept saying, "Father, Father, Father, I thank you."

The father would say, "You need to thank your elder brother because of the price he paid to get you out."

The Father Himself loves us because we have loved Jesus. My fellowship with the Father is possible because of Jesus. I have this fellowship with my Father because of Jesus. The Father loves me because I love Jesus, and I love Jesus because He has put me back into fellowship with my Father. He made something possible that was not possible.

I am finding out more and more how much it pleases my Father when I stop along the way to present my petition, and before I offer it, I allow the Holy Spirit to bring me into the presence of Jesus and teach me how to worship Him.

The Father Himself loves you because you love Jesus.

Before I offer my petition to the Father, I want the Holy Spirit to teach me how to stop and worship the Man who made all this possible.

Jesus said:

Call no man your master: for one is your Master, even Christ.

He also said we are brethren and have one Father, who is God.

I read the autobiography of a multimillionaire who was quite successful. One of the principles he gave for key management was that no matter who he had in his office, whether a janitor or a vice president, that person received his undivided attention for the duration of the visit.

How much more when I enter the presence of my Lord and King, who has reinstated my fellowship with the Father? When I enter the presence of this King, I will do so with protocol. I am going to find out what pleases Him when I enter His presence.

I found out worship pleases Him.

In the prerequisites to offering my petition, Jesus warned against hypocrisy. He warned against repetition like the heathen make. In warning against hypocrisy, He said the Pharisees prayed on street corners and in synagogues to be seen by men.

He called that a state of hypocrisy. They wanted to appear to men to be in God's presence, but the only presence they were in was the presence of the men they were praying in front of.

He warned against hypocrisy: a person who prays and worships God in a public assembly only to be seen by the people around him. You lift your hands because they do. You say the words because they do. You do not have to worry about whether you have a private prayer life. You do not.

Why would you have a private prayer life if the only time you pray or worship God is in church service simply because you want the people around you to esteem you as something you are not?

In warning against this hypocrisy, I started realizing that we have much of the same thing today. People go to church and go through the motions. Although their voice and body are in church, they are somewhere else. Wherever they are, it is not in His presence.

Many times we come hoping the preacher will preach us out of it, or the worship team will worship us out of it. We stand there without entering in ourselves, hoping they can make a strong enough pull on us that we will feel something and come into the service and be taken into His presence.

But I am finding out what pleases Jesus: do not wait.

If we are singing corporately in church, why wait until you feel something to empty yourself into every statement of adoration?

Where His train fills the temple, my voice and body are not going to be in church while I am somewhere else. I do not like hypocrisy. I am going to enter the presence of my King. If a multimillionaire had enough respect for a janitor or a vice president to give him undivided attention, then when I enter the presence of my King, one thing is certain: my soul is going to learn how to give Him undivided attention for the time I am in His presence.

If my Father loves the fellowship He has with me, and the increase of my love for the Father comes by increasing my love for the Man who put me back into fellowship with my Father, then before I enter the Father's presence with a petition, I will stop and worship the elder Son, my Master, Jesus, who made this fellowship possible.

Jesus had just blessed the little children. Matthew 19:15 says He laid His hands on them, and they departed from Him. Then the rich young ruler came and asked Jesus some things.

Matthew 19:16 says:

And, behold, one came and said unto him, Good Master, what good thing shall I do, that I may have eternal life?

And he said unto him, Why callest thou me good? there is none good but one, that is, God: but if thou wilt enter into life, keep the commandments.

He saith unto him, Which? Jesus said, Thou shalt do no murder, Thou shalt not commit adultery, Thou shalt not steal, Thou shalt not bear false witness,

Honour thy father and thy mother: and, Thou shalt love thy neighbour as thyself.

It may interest you to know that part of honoring father and mother included the children putting up a retirement fund for them. They put money aside to honor father and mother.

Jesus was upset with the priests who said that if you did not honor your father and mother, you would die the death, but then excused it if they were profited by it. They excused the stoning if the money laid up for the parents' retirement was given to the priest.

One thing this rich young ruler could boast about was that he had kept these commandments. Jesus listed honoring father and mother, and loving your neighbor as yourself.

Verse 20 says:

The young man saith unto him, All these things have I kept from my youth up: what lack I yet?

Jesus said unto him, If thou wilt be perfect, go and sell that thou hast, and give to the poor, and thou shalt have treasure in heaven: and come and follow me.

But when the young man heard that saying, he went away sorrowful: for he had great possessions.

Without saying outright that the man could not love his neighbor as himself, Jesus exposed it. If he had the capacity to love his neighbor as himself, he would have been able to give his fortune to his neighbor.

Jesus simply said, "If you want to be perfect, go sell what you have, give to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven. Then come and follow Me."

This upset the disciples.

Then said Jesus unto his disciples, Verily I say unto you, That a rich man shall hardly enter into the kingdom of heaven.

And again I say unto you, It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.

When his disciples heard it, they were exceedingly amazed, saying, Who then can be saved?

But Jesus beheld them, and said unto them, With men this is impossible; but with God all things are possible.

There were things in this encounter that puzzled me. One was Jesus saying, "Why callest thou Me good? There is none good but One, that is, God."

How could we not call Jesus good? He is the spotless Son of God, the Lamb. If He had sinned, He would not have qualified to take our judgment. He was made to be sin; He did not sin. To qualify to become my sin, He had to be free from sin, yet capable of every judgment and temptation that

Adam failed to stand under, or redemption would have been illegal and Satan could have claimed a mistrial.

Jesus had to walk in absolute perfection to pass everything required to be my Redeemer. Yet out of His own mouth He said, "Why callest thou Me good? There is none good but One, that is, God."

Then He said, "If you want to be perfect, sell what you have and do not give it to Me. Give it to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven."

If you would like to know what the rich young ruler traded his wealth on earth for, I can tell you. He chose to keep his wealth and traded it for a thousand-year reign in the Millennium. That would have hurt me.

When Jesus said, "Do not call Me good," He was speaking in the sense of the Pharisees and Sadducees, because the rich young ruler approached Him in the same light.

Rich men often carry an authority that makes people stand up and take notice. They develop it because they are used to everything they say being carried out instantly. They expect you to do what they ask. They do not even have to say they are rich; it is an aura they radiate.

I have always wanted to serve them. They come walking in the room, and you want to jump up, get out of the way, and open the door for them.

Whenever I would land my airplane at the small FBOs, these men would land in Learjets. They would stride across with ostrich-skin briefcases, with two or three accountants running behind and ahead of them to open the door. I wanted to open the door myself, but the accountants would knock you down going by.

They project authority. They can wave their hand and change things. "Take that building down. Put another one up. I want an army; I will buy one. I want the presidency; I will buy it." They are used to having what they want.

Even though the rich young ruler loved God, he was used to having things the way he wanted them.

Today there are many wealthy men who love God. They really do love God, but they are still used to having things the way they want them. They buy their way onto boards. I know several ministries where you can get on their board for a measly fifty thousand dollars. If you do, they will even fly across the country to marry you if you want to remarry.

It is not that these men mean to be that way. They are used to giving orders. Pretty soon the pastor sees the influence, the money, the people bowing, and before long the wealthy man is sitting on the board issuing orders. The pastor does not want to lose all that.

One of the biggest shocks in heaven may be when many rich men find out that many of their friends were bought, and were not really their friends at all. They may find out that some of those preachers did not like them either. They tolerated them because they gave money.

We do not have to worry about that here. I have insulted more than I have kept. I want to keep them all, but I got tired of being bought.

I was bought several times. Although it checked my spirit, everyone else was doing it, so I thought that must be the way you are supposed to walk.

This rich young ruler had been used to buying his way onto the boards of Pharisees and Sadducees. He loved the chief places at dinners. He liked to sit at the head of the table.

What good is it to have all that money in the bank if you are not going to weld two Lexuses together and drive them down the street? At least you have to sit at the head of the table.

Jesus talked about the nature that can have the ministry of simplicity, which is a ministry of giving. He says not to let your left hand know what your right hand is doing. Most people captured by money will not give unless they have a trumpet in the other hand.

If you are really going to become a gospel entrepreneur, one who does not have a trumpet in one hand, then you are going to have to let the Holy Spirit purge you like He has purged few men.

This is what Jesus means later when He says:

Many are called, but few are chosen.

He was talking about reward. Few men have forsaken enough of their lives to become chosen by God for the reward He has for those who have forsaken all. Very few qualify.

Only a few times in the generations have men allowed God to go into that place where He trained them for this and caused them to be chosen. When you live next to enough power to devastate a nation, do not think it will not affect you. It will.

There is only one way to be prepared for the ministry of an entrepreneur for the gospel: you have to let the Holy Spirit do His work in you.

The rich young ruler could not love his neighbor as himself. It became impossible to him. When Jesus said, "Do not call Me good," He was rejecting the kind of good the Pharisees, Sadducees, and scribes boasted of having.

He was saying, "Do not put Me in the same category. Flattery backed up by wealth will not get you onto the advisory board of this ministry. Why callest thou Me good? There is only one good, and that is the Father. Your flattery will not buy your way into this ministry as it has bought your way into other ministries."

Then Jesus proved it:

"You cannot love your neighbor as yourself. If you could, you could give your money to the poor."

This man was rich. Jesus said, "Take your fortune and give it to the poor. Then you will truly fulfill that last commandment. You will love your neighbor as yourself. You will trade your earthly possessions for treasure in heaven. Then come and follow Me, and you will become one of the chosen."

He could not do it because he did not have the nature to do it. The money had more hold on him than he had on the money.

Ecclesiastes says:

For God giveth to a man that is good in his sight wisdom, and knowledge, and joy: but to the sinner he giveth travail, to gather and to heap up, that he may give to him that is good before God.

To the man who is good in God's sight, He gives wisdom, knowledge, and joy. That is all you need. You do not need the money first, because wisdom employs knowledge, and joy sustains you. That causes the transfer from the sinner's hands into yours, O anointed funnel.

To the sinner He gives travail, to gather and heap up, that he may give it to the man who is good in God's sight. The transfer from the sinner's hands to your hands is made through wisdom that employs knowledge, sustained by joy.

James said:

Count it all joy when ye fall into divers temptations; knowing this, that the trying of your faith worketh patience.

Joy sustains you through every adventure when you take the wisdom of God, employ knowledge, outsmart the devil, and funnel another billion into the gospel, all in a day's work.

We got into something interesting Sunday when I went off into the Spirit. I told you about our call to Japan and the day coming when I will stand on the shores of Japan.

God has privileged us with accepting the challenge of the strong man. There has been no revival in the history of Japan, only trickles and little waves. A mega church there is around two hundred. All Protestant believers represent about one percent of the Japanese population.

We have a strong man there laughing at the West and boasting of no revival.

One time when Yonggi Cho went there, a principality appeared in his motel room and threatened to kill him. He called Lester Sumrall, and Lester said, "Send him to my room."

Any time you warrant a visit from the prince of a nation warning you to get out or he will kill you, there is quite a prize there.

I am hoping God looked at you and me and saw strength, both in character and in calling, not only to receive the kind of anointing that can shut him down, but also for many of you to become so incredibly blessed by God that you have Japan in your back pocket for the gospel.

The day will come when many of you and I will stand on that shore. Our worn-out gospel eyes, tired from looking at too much religion, will see the crutches, wheelchairs, and ambulances. We will see the glory of God escape one location with the velocity of a shockwave and ripple through Japan before Jesus comes back.

You might as well know now that the principality of Japan will consort with principalities over America and conspire to stop us on this side before we ever put our feet over there.

The devil does not like me. We are even now, because there is not a thing about him I like. Anyone who would get a nation to faithfully serve him, then starve them to death and discard them like broken humanity, is sick. He deserves none of your respect. He is a killer.

If you misjudge him, he will kill you. That warning does not come from me. Jesus said:

 | The thief cometh not, but for to steal, and to kill, and to destroy.

You can meditate for a millennium and not come up with any other reason. It is one purpose in three parts: steal, kill, destroy.

He is likened to a serpent because when he strikes, he intends not to leave you alive. Since his light went out, that is all he does. He has a trained host of principalities under him who do not know anything else. They single out people and groups to kill and destroy.

He knows if he could kill me before I enter in, he would have less trouble with you. Brace yourself, because he is going to get to you, because he is not going to kill me.

Do you think the devil would be mad at me if we had some part in the revival of Japan? Do you think he would try to kill me? Do you think I should stay in prayer almost day and night and add fastings from time to time? If he has my name written down and really wants to kill me, would it be wise to stay in the presence of God and keep delivering the power?

Yes, because we would be responsible for the anointing in the services that cause the revival.

But what if you paid for it? Do you not think he would be as mad at you for paying for it as he is at me for delivering it?

There are not very many gospel entrepreneurs. When there are a few, the devil makes sure their giving is done where it does not do much good. The one who paid for it is as dangerous as the one who delivered it. Your rewards will be the same.

These are two members in the body of Christ fulfilling each of their measures, and the two measures make one whole. All the different measures in the body of Christ, when put together, make one whole. A measure is part of the whole.

If he fulfills his measure and I fulfill mine, then on the day we stand before Jesus with millions of souls on our account, I will be rewarded for being faithful in handling the anointing in the area I minister in. The entrepreneurs will be rewarded for being faithful in the areas of incredible anointings of wisdom that came down, shut the devil's operation down, and harvested incredible funds and supplies for the kingdom.

Jesus even delivered money from a fish's mouth when He prayed.

You are as dangerous as I am. Do you think the devil will be mad at you? Do you think you will not have to pastor your business? Do you think you will not have to get acquainted with Jesus?

By the time He pours that much wisdom on you, you will either have the character to develop it, or the money will have you and it will not have come from Him at all. But if it is Him, then you will have the character to handle it, and you will lay up reward in heaven so rich that Jesus will place you in a seat of authority in the Millennium and say:

Many were called, but few were chosen.

Come and be part of My government and reign with Me a thousand years.

If you are a weakling and will not reign here, you will not reign there. That is why He said many are called, few are chosen. You will make it, all right, but you will not reign. You will be the one taking orders, not giving them.

What are you doing with your anointing?

Many are called, few are chosen. What are you doing with it?

I glorify You, my Father. I magnify You. I adore You. You minister the path, Father, and I will walk in it. You make me see it, and I will take it. You illuminate it, and I will go through it. I know it is in the development of my character. Show me how to die, and I will die.

Notice the reaction of the apostles. When Jesus said how hard it is for a rich man to enter the kingdom of God, did you notice their reaction?

"My God, who can be saved?"

I can see them thinking of the Jewish nation going straight to hell. But do you know who they were thinking of? Themselves.

Peter had a fishing franchise. Matthew was a tax collector. Have you ever seen a poor one? Luke was a physician.

When they exclaimed, "Who can be saved?" it was a rightful exclamation.

Jesus answered:

With men this is impossible; but with God all things are possible.

What made it possible?

Jesus said:

Verily I say unto you, That a rich man shall hardly enter into the kingdom of heaven.

And again I say unto you, It is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle, than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.

The statement created imagery that caused them to cry out, "Who can be saved?"

In our Western minds, we try to pass a camel through the eye of a sewing needle. If that is what they saw, no wonder they exclaimed.

But I found a book that referenced another book and told about the customs of that day. The outer gate had a security inner gate. The outer gate was the big main gate for daily traffic. The inner gate was a security gate. They called it the eye of the needle because it was carved in the shape of a camel's back or hump so that only the hump of the camel could pass through.

It was a security gate in case Jerusalem was under attack. They could close the outside gate and still let people in and out without worrying about an army suddenly invading.

When a traveler came with wealth, supplies, and trading goods strapped to the camel's back, he had to take the supplies and saddlebags off, get the camel down on its knees, and the camel would wiggle through the eye of the needle. It would just clear the back of the camel. Then they would drag the goods through.

Jesus said, "With men this is impossible, but with God all things are possible."

The eye of the needle was a type of death, spiritual death.

Jesus left the extravagance of heaven. Opulence does not mean extremely wealthy; opulence is what the extremely wealthy esteem as wealthy. Jesus left glory, streets paved with gold, no sense of lack, incredible peace, no corruption, no decay, uninterrupted quietness of tranquility.

He left that place of opulence on a mission from God. He laid all His wealth aside and was found in fashion as a man.

For ye know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that, though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor, that ye through his poverty might be rich.

He laid His wealth aside for the sole reason of entering through the gate of spiritual death and bearing your poverty. On the other side of the gate, He could give you His nature so you could inherit His inheritance.

What was impossible for men became possible for God. He Himself bore my poverty and my death so I could receive His nature. Because I have received His nature, I can inherit His wealth without His wealth doing to me what it did to the rich young ruler.

A walk into that is not without a price.

Let me show you what Jesus asked the rich young ruler to trade his wealth for. Go to Mark 10:26:

And they were astonished out of measure, saying among themselves, Who then can be saved?

And Jesus looking upon them saith, With men it is impossible, but not with God: for with God all things are possible.

Then Peter began to say unto him, Lo, we have left all, and have followed thee.

And Jesus answered and said, Verily I say unto you, There is no man that hath left house, or brethren, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my sake, and the gospel's,

But he shall receive an hundredfold now in this time, houses, and brethren, and sisters, and mothers, and children, and lands, with persecutions; and in the world to come eternal life.

Notice what you get a hundredfold of: houses, brothers, sisters, mothers, children, and lands. Even though the man left his wife, Jesus did not add wife to the list again. You are not going to inherit a hundred wives. He skipped wife and went to lands. Good substitute.

Notice also: with persecutions.

Most bank teachers strike that part out.

Jesus said no man has forsaken lands, houses, mother, father, sisters, brothers, and children for His sake and the gospel's sake who will not receive a hundredfold. But He said it in the light of people giving their lives, forsaking everything for the gospel's sake. Whether anyone went with them or not, they went anyway.

If all the inheritance were wealth, as most of us teach it, then the rich young ruler was already rich. His first step into God's prosperity was his willingness to trade his earthly wealth for treasures in heaven.

What treasure would he have laid up in heaven? The hundredfold of houses, brethren, sisters, mothers, children, and lands. You cannot buy brethren. The houses are in the same light. You cannot buy mothers, fathers, children, and lands in the way Jesus meant it.

The first step to God's prosperity, where He will make you rich, is using it to lay treasures up in heaven: the thousands of mothers, brothers, sisters, and children added to the gospel because of the proper use of your fortune.

Paul showed the persecution involved. He did not label it "the mighty apostle Paul." He said a messenger from hell came after him because of the abundance of revelations. It centered in on him and shook him to his knees three times until he cried for God to help him.

God kept telling him:

My grace is sufficient for thee.

Paul finally realized that when he switched his dependency from the flesh to the Spirit, then when he was weakest, he was strongest. When he stripped himself of dependency on the flesh and placed it on the Spirit, he became strongest because it caused the power of Christ to rest on him. That is grace.

There is persecution with the office of an apostle, but there is also persecution with this office of the one who forsakes everything and says, "Jesus, I am Yours. I have died to this world. I will walk with You and go with You whether anybody goes with me or not."

It is nice when they do, but it does not release you when they do not.

Go back to Matthew. Matthew picks up a little more detail in one place and less in another.

Matthew 19:26 says:

But Jesus beheld them, and said unto them, With men this is impossible; but with God all things are possible.

Then answered Peter and said unto him, Behold, we have forsaken all, and followed thee; what shall we have therefore?

Peter was brave enough to say what hardly anyone says in their humble state: "What do we get out of it?"

Peter always had something to say about everything. "The tree Thou cursed is withered away." "If it be You, Master, bid me come." "How many times do I have to forgive this guy? Seventy times seven?"

So why be shocked when Jesus said what He did and Peter asked, "We have forsaken everything to follow You. What do we get?"

I am glad I did not have to ask it, but I am sure going to glean His answer.

Verse 28:

And Jesus said unto them, Verily I say unto you, That ye which have followed me, in the regeneration when the Son of man shall sit in the throne of his glory, ye also shall sit upon twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.

That word "regeneration" is another word Jesus used for the Millennial reign. He is talking about the thousand-year Millennial reign.

For the twelve, that is real good. They get to sit on twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel. But how about us, two thousand years later? We are spiritual seed, Gentile Christian believers, seed of Christ according to the promise, children of Abraham.

He covers us in the next verse:

And every one that hath forsaken houses, or brethren, or sisters, or father, or mother, or wife, or children, or lands, for my name's sake, shall receive an hundredfold, and shall inherit everlasting life.

But many that are first shall be last; and the last shall be first.

Everyone who has forsaken houses, brethren, sisters, father, mother, wife, children, or lands for His name's sake shall receive a hundredfold and inherit everlasting life.

Matthew leaves out some of the details Mark gives about the hundredfold, and Mark leaves out the detail about the regeneration and the apostles sitting on twelve thrones. Putting the two together, we get the full picture.

The passage is about the regeneration, the Millennium, and Jesus is still explaining hundredfold prosperity and eternal reward.

Matthew 20 should not have been separated from Matthew 19 the way the King James chapter division makes it feel. Jesus has not changed the subject.

Matthew 20:16 says:

So the last shall be first, and the first last: for many be called, but few chosen.

That sounds like Matthew 19:30:

But many that are first shall be last; and the last shall be first.

That means He has not changed the subject. He is still working on you understanding hundredfold prosperity and your eternal reward.

I can tell you what He is talking about: those who forsook all to follow Him. Short of that, you will not be chosen to reign in the Millennium.

Of the twelve, ten gave themselves to martyrdom. Bartholomew was flayed alive. They ripped the skin off his body. Thomas was thrust through by a spear in India. James was beheaded. Peter was crucified upside down. Paul was beheaded.

John lived out his days. He was the one who walked in enough love for Jesus to commit His mother to him. You can rest assured John honored His mother. John stayed alive to see the end of her days. He was faithful all the way through and hated sin. He stayed with Jesus all the way to the cross. That is why, in His last moments, Jesus said:

John, behold thy mother.

I would like Him to be able to do that to me.

Peter and Paul came out in due season, trained by Jesus. But Jesus said anyone--anyone--who has forsaken houses and lands and paid the price will receive a hundredfold. The kind of reward you get back is treasure in heaven.

One thing is certain: He cannot keep treasure in heaven coming in without replenishing the wealth the rich man would have given away to see treasure in heaven. That is not the key to getting by; it is the key to being smarter than any strategies the devil can train to sin against you.

Matthew 20:1 says:

For the kingdom of heaven is like unto a man that is an householder, which went out early in the morning to hire labourers into his vineyard.

The householder is Jesus. The laborers are you. The vineyard is the kingdom of God. He agreed with the laborers for a penny a day and sent them into the vineyard. Then He brings laborers in at different hours and pays them all the same.

Second Peter 3 says:

One day is with the Lord as a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day.

From Adam to Noah was roughly two thousand years. Noah to Jesus, another stretch. From Jesus to our day, nearly two thousand more. Creation in Genesis shows that on the seventh day God rested. That seventh day is a picture of the one-thousand-year Millennial reign.

Did you notice what the householder contracted with them for? A penny a day.

Jesus said to the twelve who had forsaken all to follow Him that during the regeneration, the Millennium, they would sit with Him on twelve thrones judging the twelve tribes of Israel. For the rest of you, anyone who forsakes all, no matter when you get in on this, He contracts with you for a penny a day, and you will reign with Him in the Millennium.

You are not going to inherit millions of mothers, fathers, children, houses, and lands naturally. You inherit them by bringing them into the kingdom of God.

In the rich young ruler's case, Jesus addressed what he had forsaken and what the apostles would inherit for following the Lamb wherever He goes.

Why not buy yourself a kingdom with all the people in it and bring them to heaven with you?

"How do I do that? I am not the preacher."

You are the entrepreneur. Find the biggest, most powerful, most anointed mouth you can lay your hands on and pay the fire out of him to sweep them into the kingdom.

Revelation 20:1 says:

And I saw an angel come down from heaven, having the key of the bottomless pit and a great chain in his hand.

And he laid hold on the dragon, that old serpent, which is the Devil, and Satan, and bound him a thousand years,

And cast him into the bottomless pit, and shut him up, and set a seal upon him, that he should deceive the nations no more, till the thousand years should be fulfilled: and after that he must be loosed a little season.

Notice the nations.

Then verse 4 says:

And I saw thrones, and they sat upon them, and judgment was given unto them...

Right after the instigation of the Millennium, the first thing John sees is thrones and judgment given to them.

Jesus told Peter that those who left all to follow Him would sit on twelve thrones judging the twelve tribes of Israel. Then John sees thrones, and judgment is given to those who sit on them.

Revelation continues:

And I saw the souls of them that were beheaded for the witness of Jesus, and for the word of God, and which had not worshipped the beast, neither his image, neither had received his mark upon their foreheads, or in their hands; and they lived and reigned with Christ a thousand years.

This is another harvest, and He is by no means done yet. On these people, the second death has no hold.

So Jesus said the last will be first and the first will be last; many are called, but few are chosen.

All through the ages, He contracted with them for a penny a day. Hebrews 11 says that although the elders of the old covenant received a good report by faith, they did not receive the promise, that without us they should not be made perfect.

The last shall be first, and the first shall be last. We are the last to come in, but the first to receive this walk with Jesus. The old covenant saints were kept in Abraham's bosom until He released them and brought them into heaven.

Through those ages, many were called, but few were chosen.

Called to what? He contracted with every one of them for a penny a day. The few are chosen because not many have followed the Lamb wherever He went, whether in their covenant or ours.

He gave everything. Those who follow Him that way will reign with Him.

What did you think He was choosing you for? Salvation? A ministry? A mighty anointing? You were not called and then left unchosen for the calling because you walked in sin. What did you think He was qualifying you for?

The last shall be first, and the first last. Many are called, but few are chosen.